Bow Valley College

Course Outline

VFXP2303

Visual Effects: Simulation
Spring 2024 - Spring 2025

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VFXP2303 Visual Effects: Simulation

COURSE DESCRIPTION

In this course, students will learn the basics of FX in Houdini. Through the use of optimization, students will be introduced to proceduralism, including randomization, particle velocity, and position, the basics of Houdini's scripting language VEX, RBD simulations, and basic output render attributes.

REQUISITES	Complete the following courses: • VFXP1601 - Fundamentals of Texturing and Lighting for Visual Effects (3) • VFXP1703 - Careers in Visual Effects (3) • VFXP2201 - Producing for Visual Effects (3) • VFXP2501 - Visual Effects: Intermediate Video Compositing (3)
EQUIVALENTS	None
CREDITS	3
HOURS	75
ELIGIBLE FOR PLAR	No
ZERO TEXTBOOK COST	Yes

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Bow Valley College is committed to ensuring our graduates can demonstrate their abilities in key areas that will make them effective citizens and encourage their development as lifelong learners. In addition to the discipline-specific skills that learners acquire in their programs, the College has identified ten learning outcomes.

College-Wide Outcomes:

1. Communication
2. Thinking Skills
3. Numeracy and Financial Literacy
4. Working with Others
5. Digital Literacy
6. Positive Attitudes and Behaviours
7. Continuous Learning
8. Health and Wellness Awareness
9. Citizenship and Intercultural Competence

10. Environmental Sustainability

#	COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	COLLEGE WIDE OUTCOMES SUPPORTED
1	Navigate the Houdini interface.	2, 5
2	Produce FX using real-life references.	1, 2, 4, 5
3	Produce 3D effects using Houdini's various facets, such as procedural geometry, rigid body (RDB) simulations, pyro FX.	1, 2, 5
4	Create film quality FX.	2, 5

COURSE MODULES AND SCHEDULE

**Course schedule subject to change, depending on delivery mode and term of study. For exact dates, please consult the Course Offering Information in Brightspace.*

WEEK/HOURS	MODULES
Week 1	Course introduction
Week 2	Channel expressions and iterating
Week 3	Instance geometry workflow
Week 4	A guide to all things Mantra
Week 5	FBX Imports and Pop out Effect (POPs)
Week 6	Attributes and DOP parameters
Week 7	VEX and how to make it work for you
Week 8	Custom POP simulations and pipelines
Week 9	Rigid body dynamics (RBD)
Week 10	RBD
Week 11	RBD
Week 12	Volumetrics
Week 13	Volumetrics
Week 14	Deep compositing and FX integration
Week 15	Final project presentations

ASSESSMENT

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	ASSESSMENT	WEIGHT
1, 2, 3, 4	Attendance	10%
1, 2, 3, 4	Professionalism	10%
1, 2, 3, 4	Assignments (Minimum 3)	50%
1, 2, 3, 4	Final Project	30%

Important: For details on each assignment and exam, please see the Course Offering Information.

PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

A minimum grade of D is required to pass this course. However, a program may require a higher grade in this course to progress in the program or to meet specific program completion requirements.

Please consult with the program area or contact the program chair for further details. A minimum Grade Point Average of 2.0 is required for graduation.

GRADING SCHEME

Grade	Percentage	Grade Point	Description
A+	95-100	4.0	Exceptional: superior knowledge of subject matter
A	90-94	4.0	Excellent: outstanding knowledge of subject matter
A-	85-89	3.67	
B+	80-84	3.33	
B	75-79	3.0	Very Good: knowledge of subject matter generally mastered
B-	70-74	2.67	
C+	67-69	2.33	
C	64-66	2.0	Satisfactory/Acceptable: knowledge of subject matter adequately mastered
C-	60-63	1.67	
D+	57-59	1.33	
D	50-56	1.0	Minimal Pass
F	Less than 50	0.0	Fail: an unsatisfactory performance

REQUIRED LEARNING RESOURCES

Additional learning resources may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

The following software will be taught and will be provided to students. Technology is subject to change based on industry.

- Houdini

Language and assessments in this program are based on the partnership with the Alberta Centre for Entertainment Arts.

Additional information may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

Learners with a disability (learning, physical, and/or mental health) may qualify for academic and exam accommodations. For more information, or to apply for accommodations, learners should make an appointment with Accessibility Services in the Learner Success Services (LSS) Department. Accessibility Services can also assist learners who may be struggling with learning but do not have a formal diagnosis. To make an appointment visit LSS on the first floor of the south campus or call 403-410-1440. It is the learner's responsibility to contact Accessibility Services and request academic accommodations. For more information, please visit our website at http://www.bowvalleycollege.ca/accessibility.

INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Bow Valley College is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Learners are urged to become familiar with and uphold the following policies: Academic Integrity (500-1-7), Learner Code of Conduct, Procedures and Guidelines (500-1-1), Learner Appeals (500-1-12), Attendance (500-1-10), Grading (500-1-6), Academic Continuance and Graduation (500-1-5), and Electronic Communications (300-2-13). Audio or video recording of lectures, labs, seminars, or any other teaching and learning environment by learners is allowed only with consent of the instructor as part of an approved accommodation plan. Recorded material is to be used solely for personal study and is not being used or distributed without prior written consent from the instructor.

Turnitin:

Students may be required to submit their course work to Turnitin, a third-party service provider engaged by BVC. Turnitin identifies plagiarism by checking databases of electronic books and articles, archived webpages, and previously submitted student papers. Students acknowledge that any course work or essays submitted to Turnitin will be included as source documents in the Turnitin.com reference database, where it will be used solely to detect plagiarism. The terms that apply to a student's use of Turnitin are described on Turnitin.com.

Online Exam Proctoring:

Examinations for this course may require proctoring through an online proctoring service. Online proctoring enables online exam taking within a controlled and monitored environment, thereby enhancing academic integrity. Online proctoring may occur through a variety of methods, including but not limited to:

a. live online proctoring where a remote invigilator authenticates identity and observes completion of an exam using specialized software and recordings;
b. automated proctoring where the exam session is recorded and AI (artificial intelligence) analyzed;
c. browser lockdown that limits access to other applications, websites, copying, printing, screen capture and other functions; or
d. a combination of both live/automated proctoring and browser lockdown.

Course instructors will review recordings, analyses, and data obtained through online proctoring for academic integrity infractions. It is the student's responsibility to meet the technical, software, location, and identity verification requirements necessary to enable online proctoring.

Further details of these policies are available in the Academic Calendar and on the Bow Valley College website, bowvalleycollege.ca.

Learners are encouraged to keep a copy of this course outline for future reference.

Collection of Personal Information:

This course, including your image and voice, may be recorded and made available to you and other students taking the course section. By attending the class(es) online or in person, you consent to the collection of your personal information. If you do not wish to be recorded, please contact your instructor before starting the course/class to discuss alternative arrangements.

You may use the recordings only for educational purposes and you must not copy, share, or use the recordings for any other purpose without the instructor's express permission.

Your personal information is collected in accordance with section 33(c) of the Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (Alberta) to deliver academic programming, support learner flexibility, promote universal design for learning principles, and for purposes consistent with the course activities and outcomes. If you have any questions about the collection, disclosure, use, or protection of this information, please contact the College's Access and Privacy Officer at foip@bowvalleycollege.ca.